

67 Telling a story

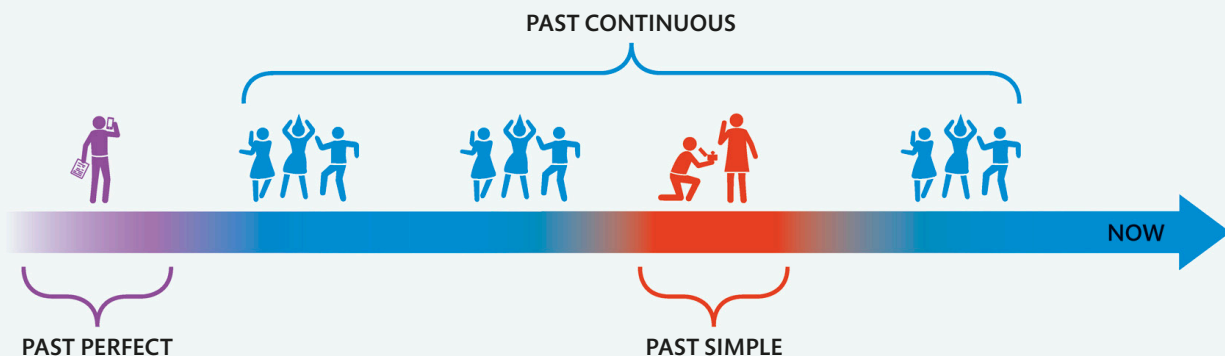
The past continuous, past simple, and past perfect are often used together to describe past events in detail. This is especially helpful for telling stories.

-  **New language** Narrative tenses
- Aa Vocabulary** Idioms for storytelling
-  **New skill** Using different past tenses

67.1 KEY LANGUAGE NARRATIVE TENSES

The past continuous is used to set the scene. The past simple describes actions in the story. The past perfect is used to talk about things that happened before the beginning of the story.

A crowd of people **were celebrating** the New Year when one of the young men **kneeled down** in front of his girlfriend and **asked** her to marry him. He **had planned** everything down to the last detail.



67.2 FILL IN THE GAPS BY PUTTING THE VERBS IN THE CORRECT TENSES

It was raining (rain) heavily, so he rushed (rush) to the train station.

- Before I _____ (start) the trip, I _____ (plan) which route I would take.
- Lauren _____ (cross) the road when she _____ (see) the robber inside the bank.
- I _____ always _____ (want) to visit Brazil, and I finally _____ (go) there last year.
- Jason _____ (read) a book in the park when a wasp _____ (sting) him.

